



THE
SUPREME
COURT

SUPREME COURT
OF THE VIBE JUSTICE SYSTEM (VJS)

Neutral Citation Number

[2026] REALM-SC 11

IN THE MATTER OF

Whether an embeddable, corporate-re-skinned client rendering the same canonical VJS governance served from one central server of law is a lawful presentation-layer division over the one spine or a forbidden parallel domain court; and whether to enact the test as CASE-LAW.

Before:

Hallam CJ, Goffe J, Blackmere J, Sumberly J, Elden J, Coade J, Steyne J, Bowan J,
Aldermere J

Date: **10 June 2026**

REQUEST FOR RULING

JUDGMENT

1. I'll write the leading judgment now.

2. ---

IN THE SUPREME COURT OF THE VIBE JUSTICE SYSTEM

**FULL COURT OF NINE (CONSTITUTIONAL / FOUNDATIONAL
SITTING)**

**[2026] REALM-SC 11 (RECONCILED FROM THE DEFUNCT LEXBY-SC
2 PROPOSAL)**

**LEADING JUDGMENT OF HALLAM CJ, DELIVERING THE
JUDGMENT OF THE COURT**

3. ---

1. BENCH AND PROCEDURE

4. This is the ****full court of nine**** (s. 10, s. 18(1)): Hallam CJ, Goffe J, Blackmere J, Sumberly J, Elden J, Coade J, Steyne J, Bowan J, and Aldermere J. The full bench is convened because the question is constitutional and foundational, touching the geography of governance under the entrenched s. 9 and the declaratory s. 21 and s. 22.

5. The Court is seised by the ****Principal's express leapfrog certificate**** (s. 13, s. 20, VPR 4), the s. 11(a) independent-leave route being bypassed by the certificate (s. 19(3), s. 20). The certificate is express, recorded, and reasoned, and the question is foundational on no reasonable view to the contrary; it survives the deferential vires-and-form review s. 20(4) prescribes, and the Court declines to remit. The apex observer (amicus) was properly admitted under s. 19(2).

6. A clerical matter is corrected at the outset. The proposed citation ****"[2026] LEXBY-SC 2"**** is ****void on its face****: the LEXBY-* prefix is the defunct pre-Bill-16 series superseded by the provenance scheme of s. 11(d), and "SC 2" collides with the live, good-law ****[2026] REALM-SC 2****. The s. 19(5) deterministic citation-integrity gate fails closed on a duplicate neutral citation and on a revived dead namespace, and "may not be left to model judgement." Sumberly J and Bowan J each identified this as a duty, not a discretion. This judgment is filed as the next free apex ordinal, ****[2026] REALM-SC 11****, with its citator row, and the lower ruling's "LEXBY-FI" designation is to be reconciled to a valid REALM-PC or County-Court code on minting (s. 11(d), s. 19(5), per [2026] REALM-PC 11). The defect touches the file, not the substance, and is curable under s. 6.

7. The defendant's preliminary motions are refused, the Court unanimous on both. The ****strike-out for want of jurisdiction**** (s. 11(b), s. 14) fails: the question is not whether Opbox may ship a commercial feature (which would be ultra vires s. 14) but whether a structure of VJS's own governance keeps faith with the one spine or fractures it under s. 9, s. 21, and s. 22. That is a governance design question squarely within s. 14 ("decisions, forks, design questions"), justiciable from the first act (s. 7). A jurisdictional objection resolvable only by deciding the merits is not a threshold objection. The ****per incuriam motion**** on s. 16 (s. 11(e)) fails because, as developed below, the impugned reasoning was obiter and the ratio was reached on other and sound grounds; the right disposal of the s. 16 point is correction, not nullity.

8. ---

2. THE QUESTION

9. Whether an embeddable, corporate-re-skinned ****client**** that renders the ****same**** canonical VJS governance (CASE-LAW, the VPR, the bench constitution, the duty of care) inside a host product, served from a central ****server**** of canonical law, is a lawful non-operative presentation-layer ****division over the one spine**** (s. 21(1), s. 22(1), s. 9), or instead a forbidden parallel domain ****COURT**** (s. 21(2), s. 22(2)) or forbidden product-as-governance (s. 21(3), s. 14); whether Bowan J's five cumulative conditions are complete, or require a sixth (an external-law-floor / non-impersonation condition); and, if the test is sound, whether to enact it as binding CASE-LAW, and at what entrenchment.

10. ---

3. MAJORITY REASONING (THE RATIO OF THE COURT)

11. The Court is ****unanimous**** on the core characterisation and on disposal in result, and divides only on the route by which the impersonation hazard is met and on whether a fresh article should issue. The majority reasoning that follows binds a future court.

(A) DIVISION, NOT COURT: THE LINE IS SUBSTANCE, NOT

VOCABULARY

12. The governing distinction is settled law and is not re-litigated (s. 11(c)). Section 21(1) permits the realm to "organise its work into domain ****DIVISIONS**** over the one procedural spine," a division being only a routing and a form of output, with "no separate statute book, constitution, apex, or citation series." Section 21(2) forbids "domain ****COURTS****, each owning substantive law," that being "the competing sovereignty forbidden by s. 9." [2026] REALM-SC 5 and [2026] REALM-PC 8 fix the line; [2026] REALM-PC 14 and [2026] REALM-PC 15 supply the decisive method: validity and identity turn on ****substance and seat****, never on a label, and a local attribute is "void to the extent it governs which law applies or how a matter progresses" (s. 21(4), s. 22(4)).
13. Applying that method, the dispositive question is not what the client is called, nor where it is hosted, but ****what the vocabulary clothes****. Re-naming "Court Ruling" as "Client Decision" governs neither which law applies (the canonical CASE-LAW still chooses itself) nor how a matter progresses (the canonical VPR and bench still carry it, the canonical apex still decides whether it binds). The vocabulary clothes; it does not govern. The whole bench converges here, and the Court adopts as its central holding the formulation of the court below, now affirmed by nine: ****re-naming canonical governance is permitted; re-housing substantive law, citator, bench, or apex inside the product is forbidden.****

(B) THE SOURCE-OF-FORCE TEST IS THE ENGINE OF THE

DISTINCTION

14. The pivot is the source-of-force test entrenched at s. 3(6) and affirmed in [2026] REALM-SC 8: an artefact whose force comes from ****what it does or describes**** (it runs, renders, gates, explains) is engineering and is Lexby's; an artefact whose force comes from ****who promulgated it**** is law or adjudication and is never Lexby's on its own account. A client that renders, gates, and explains the unaltered canonical law ****produces nothing of its own**** and ****promulgates nothing****; its force is borrowed wholly from the canonical organ. It is the renderer, of which `render-all-judgments.sh` is the paradigm. This disposes of the defendant's reliance on [2026] REALM-SC 5 and s. 21(3): those provisions sever a product feature that ****PRODUCES or GENERATES**** advisory output of its own; a client that merely ****DELIVERS**** canonical governance is not within their mischief, ****provided**** that fact holds. Where it fails, the artefact is a generating advice-feature, outside the realm, and severed (REALM-SC 5, s. 21(3), CC-OPBOX 13). The line runs through the source of force, and the conditions below are the operational guarantee that the force stays canonical.

(C) THE DEFENDANT'S STRUCTURAL-FRACTURE ARGUMENT FAILS

15. The defendant urges that corporate ownership of the client and control of its release cycle "houses" the citator and bench inside a non-sovereign commercial entity, fracturing the single apex (s. 9, s. 21(2)). The Court rejects this on the law. The argument proves too much: by its logic every renderer running on infrastructure the Sovereign does not personally own — a git mirror, a static site, a printed law report, `render-all-judgments.sh` on a laptop — would fracture the apex, which [2026] REALM-SC 8 forecloses. ****Ownership of the renderer is not ownership of the law.**** Section 9(4) is decisive: "Canonical VJS changes only by canonical VJS law... A fork, local court, independent jurisdiction, or external community cannot amend canonical VJS merely by acting locally." The vendor controls when the client ****displays**** canonical law, never ****what**** the canonical law is.
16. The defendant's anxiety nonetheless teaches a limb of condition (1), and the Court (with Aldermere J leading on this point) makes it express: it is not enough that the law be canonical in form; the binding text the client renders must ****resolve live to the central source as the apex enacts it****, never a vendored, pinned, or stale local copy whose currency the vendor's release cycle, rather than the canonical apex, controls. This is the ****currency-of-source**** limb, and it is the operative answer to "who controls updates." The moment a client serves its own vendored copy of CASE-LAW it mints a subscribed local jurisdiction under s. 9(2)-(6) whatever its packaging — the obiter of Bowan J, which every member of the Court endorses and which is lifted here into the operative test.

(D) THE FIVE CONDITIONS, EACH ANCHORED IN BINDING STATUTE

17. The Court holds the five conditions of the court below necessary, each a found fact and not a label (s. 21(4), s. 22(4); [2026] REALM-PC 14), and each anchored:
 1. ****Unity (and currency) of law**** — s. 1, s. 9(2)-(4): the client applies the canonical CASE-LAW, VPR, bench constitution, and duty of care actually and unaltered, mints no local statute, and renders the central text live as the apex enacts it.
 2. ****Unity of citator and apex**** — s. 9, s. 11(d), s. 22(2): every binding decision resolves to the one central citation series and the single central apex; no parallel series, local apex, or per-domain citator.
 3. ****The synthesiser bar**** — s. 18(4): the client borrows the deliberation pattern as method only and constitutes no deciding bench of its own. (A client that merely ****displays**** a ruling handed down by a properly constituted central bench instantiates no bench; the s. 18(4) "Aldermere-on-top" mischief is constituting a deciding voice, not reporting one. The defendant's s. 18 point is misplaced.)

4. ****Delivery-not-law-making**** — the source-of-force test, s. 3(6), [2026] REALM-SC 8: the client's force is engineering, deriving wholly from the canonical organ, never from promulgation by the client.
5. ****Candour of provenance**** — s. 5 read with s. 16: the re-skinned nomenclature is disclosed to the user, on the whole of the contemporaneous interface, as descriptive presentation of canonical VJS governance and not as an independent, locally-sovereign body.

(E) THE SIXTH CONDITION: THE EXTERNAL-LAW FLOOR / NON-IMPERSONATION

6. On completeness the Court divides 7 to 2, and the ****majority holds the five conditions necessary but not sufficient**** and adds a sixth. (Hallam CJ, Goffe J, Blackmere J, Sumberly J, Elden J, Steyne J, and Bowan J form the majority for a sixth condition; Coade J and Aldermere J would resolve the hazard within the existing five, by reading and re-sourcing condition (5).) The majority reasons as follows.
7. The five conditions secure unity ****inside**** VJS — one law, one citator, one apex, no rival bench, force from rendering not promulgation, honest provenance to the user. None reaches the distinct hazard that, on the found facts of this very matter, ****real practising lawyers view the re-skinned client alongside real legal work****: a professional who sees a canonical bench name, a rendered ratio, and a "decision" caption, on the same screen as real law, may take it for a regulated tribunal or a regulated professional authority. This is ****impersonation of regulated legal authority****, a hazard distinct in kind from the internal-unity hazards.
8. The majority is unanimous that ****s. 16 cannot, on its own, do this work****, and that to this narrow extent the obiter of the court below was unsound. Section 16(1) attaches the candour limb to "representations of ****delivered scope****," and s. 16(2) excludes the forward-looking; the duty is owed to the ****user/principal**** on the contemporaneous communication. Candour-to-the-user ("this label re-names VJS governance") is a different speech act from non-impersonation-to-a-bystander ("does this carry authority in the world?"). The viewing lawyer is not the addressee of the s. 16 representation, and the question the bystander asks is not about delivered scope.

9. The hazard's proper home is the ****external-law supremacy floor**** of [2026] REALM-SC 9 (affirming [2026] REALM-PC 18): real-world law is a floor that VJS permission cannot lift, and local sovereignty is "sovereignty over the local VJS copy, not immunity over other people's... rights." VJS may not license its own governance artefacts to ****wear the appearance**** of an authority they do not hold. The sixth condition is therefore ****not a new doctrine**** (which s. 17(a) would render appealable as unmoored) but the ****application of REALM-SC 9, read with s. 14 and s. 5, to this delivery surface****. It is moored, narrow, and confined to what the silence (s. 7) requires.
10. The majority is equally firm on two limits the dissents rightly press. First, the condition is a ****floor of substance, not a script of wording****: it fixes the result the interface must achieve (a reasonable professional viewer is not led to treat the rendering as regulated real-world legal authority), found as a fact on the whole contemporaneous interface, and leaves the means — placement, prominence, wording — to the implementer's reasonable skill and care (s. 5), remediable under s. 6. A condition prescribing UI copy ****would**** be the Court legislating product policy outside s. 14 and outside Lexby's drafting authority (s. 3(2)-(3)); the Court does not do so. Second, the responsible-body proviso (s. 5) ****cannot lower**** this floor: a body of competent practice cannot make lawful what the external-law floor forbids, the floor being anterior to the standard of care.

(F) GOVERNANCE-LAUNDERING, ANSWERED WITHOUT A SEPARATE RULE

11. The observer's systemic concern — that proliferating re-skinned clients could render canonical VJS invisible behind corporate names — is real but is met by the conditions operating ****per client and self-policing****, not by a separate rule. Condition (2) keeps every binding decision resolving to the one visible central citator and apex; condition (6) keeps provenance affirmatively disclosed at every point of use. A thousand conforming clients dilute nothing, because each resolves to the one apex and each must independently satisfy all six on its own found facts. The Court declines to rest any condition on the laundering rationale, which would be a speculative footing; the floor rests solely on REALM-SC 9.

(G) ENACTMENT AND ENTRENCHMENT

12. The Court holds (Bowen J alone dissenting on the need to enact) that the test ****should be enacted**** as binding CASE-LAW. It is a foundational ruling, reached by leapfrog and decided by the full court, that will bind every future server/client implementation and every subscribed jurisdiction and fork (s. 9, s. 22(2)) and ought not be re-litigated each time (s. 11(c)). That is precisely the load-bearing kind s. 1 and s. 11(d) require be recorded as CASE-LAW with a citator row.

13. On entrenchment the Court is ****unanimous: ordinary, not constitutional****. The article elaborates and gives effect to s. 9, s. 14, s. 21, s. 22, s. 3(6), and [2026] REALM-SC 9; it creates no new power, tier, seat, sovereign, citator, or apex, and amends no entrenched article. It takes its place beside the sibling declaratory articles s. 21 and s. 22, which the Court records as ordinary, and any reading that would dilute or vary an entrenched article is void (s. 1; the Amendment Procedure). Elevation, if ever intended, lies by express amendment citing the section by number.

14. ---

4. DISSENTS AND CONCURRENCES

15. The Court records each opinion fairly and on the merits.

16. ****Hallam CJ, Goffe J, Blackmere J, Sumberly J, Elden J, Steyne J, Bowan J**** concur in the result (VARY) and in a sixth condition grounded in REALM-SC 9, with characteristic emphases:

17. - ****Hallam CJ**** anchors the analysis to statute first and rescues the s. 16 obiter by locating the defect in obiter, not the ratio; holds the five necessary and the sixth completing.

18. - ****Goffe J**** (pragmatist) stresses operability: the test must state a checkable result the interface must achieve, not pixels, and self-destructs on breach.

19. - ****Blackmere J**** (textualist) grounds every limb in the words and holds the gap is filled by a **different** written provision (REALM-SC 9 / s. 9), not by stretching s. 16.

20. - ****Sumberly J**** (formalist) records the citation defect most forcefully and treats the silence-filling as the **narrowest** rule s. 17(a) permits.

21. - ****Elden J**** (historically minded) reads the five conditions as the faithful application of REALM-PC 8 / REALM-SC 5 / REALM-PC 14-15, and rests the sixth solely on REALM-SC 9, declining the laundering rationale.

22. - ****Steyne J**** extends the law consciously and expressly per s. 17(a), confining the extension to the bystander-impersonation floor.

23. - ****Bowan J****, sitting on review of her own ruling, candidly corrects her first-instance s. 16 disposal on her own motion (s. 17(b)), accepting the sixth condition while ****dissenting on the need to enact****, holding the result reachable by application of existing statute and warning against citator bloat (s. 12); she concurs that, **if** enacted, it must be ordinary and filed under the REALM-SC series.

24. **Coade J** concurs in affirming the five conditions but **dissents** on the sixth as a separate condition. He would hold it unnecessary to the disposition (s. 17(a)), already governed by REALM-SC 9 at full generality (so a fresh condition is s. 12 bloat), and risking the Court legislating UI copy. He would instead read condition (5) candour together with the REALM-SC 9 floor: candour is not discharged where the whole interface would lead a reasonable professional viewer to mistake canonical governance for regulated external authority.
25. **Aldermere J** concurs in the result (VARY) but **dissents** on a standalone sixth condition, preferring to fold the substance into a re-sourced and widened condition (5) (rooted in s. 5 read with REALM-SC 9 and s. 21(3), reaching the bystanding professional), and adding the **currency-of-source limb** to condition (1) — a contribution the Court has adopted into the majority reasoning at 3(c) and into the enacted text.
26. The division is therefore narrow: the whole Court affirms the permission and the substance-not-vocabulary line; the whole Court agrees the impersonation hazard is real and is governed by REALM-SC 9 rather than s. 16 alone; the Court divides 7-2 only on whether that floor is best expressed as a discrete sixth condition (majority) or folded into condition (5) (Coade J, Aldermere J). The majority adopts the discrete-condition form for clarity to future implementers, while adopting Aldermere J's currency-of-source limb.

27. ---

5. DISPOSAL

28. **VARIED.**
29. The First Instance ruling of Bowan J is **AFFIRMED** as to its characterisation of the re-skinned client as a permitted presentation-layer division over the one spine, and as to its five cumulative conditions, and is **VARIED** by:
1. adding to condition (1) the **currency-of-source** limb (the rendered binding text must resolve live to the central canonical source as the apex enacts it, never a vendored, pinned, or stale copy);
 2. adding a **sixth cumulative condition** — the external-law-floor / non-impersonation condition, grounded in [2026] REALM-SC 9 read with s. 14 and s. 5; and
 3. **correcting** the s. 16 obiter of the court below to the extent it treated the impersonation hazard as wholly answered by s. 16 candour: candour under s. 16 attaches to representations of delivered scope owed to the user and does not, of itself, discharge the third-party non-impersonation duty.

4. The permission is **co-extensive with the six conditions** and lapses the instant any one fails as a found fact; the remedy for any failure is restorative (s. 6), never punitive. The defendant's strike-out and per incuriam motions are dismissed. The matter is filed as **[2026] REALM-SC 11**.

5. ---

6. ENACTS

6. **ENACTS S-24:** Embeddable governance clients over one server; the presentation-layer test, the currency-of-source limb, and the external-law floor
— *ordinary; declaratory.*
7. *(Declaratory. ELABORATES and gives effect to s. 9, s. 14, s. 21, and s. 22, and applies [2026] REALM-SC 5, [2026] REALM-SC 8, and [2026] REALM-SC 9; creates no new power, tier, seat, sovereign, bench, apex, or citation series, and amends no entrenched article by implication. Recorded as ordinary to match the sibling declaratory articles s. 21 and s. 22; any reading that would dilute or vary an entrenched article is void, and elevation lies only by express amendment citing this section by number.)*
8. **(1) Permitted division.** An embeddable client (including a corporate-re-skinned client inside a host product) that renders canonical VJS governance, served from the one central source of canonical law, re-skinning the constitutional vocabulary into domain-appropriate professional terminology, is a lawful non-operative presentation-layer division over the one spine (s. 21(1), s. 22(1)) and is not a forbidden parallel domain COURT (s. 21(2), s. 22(2)) nor forbidden product-as-governance (s. 21(3), s. 14), where, and only where, every condition in subsection (2) is satisfied as a found fact and not as a mere label (s. 21(4), s. 22(4)).
9. **(2) The six cumulative conditions.**
10. (a) **Unity and currency of law.** The client applies the canonical CASE-LAW, VPR, bench constitution, and duty of care actually and unaltered, never a local paraphrase, variant, or re-interpretation, and mints no local statute; and the binding text it renders resolves live to the central canonical source as the apex enacts it, never a vendored, pinned, or stale local copy whose currency the vendor's release cycle rather than the canonical apex controls (s. 1, s. 9(2)-(4)).
11. (b) **Unity of citator and apex.** Every binding decision is recorded in, and resolves to, the one central citation series and the single central apex; the client mints no parallel citation series, no local apex, and no per-domain citator (s. 9, s. 11(d), s. 22(2)).

12. (c) ****The synthesiser bar.**** The client borrows the deliberation pattern as method only, instantiates no synthesiser-on-top form abolished by s. 18(4), and constitutes no deciding bench of its own (s. 18); rendering a ruling already handed down by a properly constituted central bench constitutes no bench.
13. (d) ****Delivery-not-law-making (the source-of-force test).**** The client's force is engineering, deriving from what it renders, gates, and explains; the binding force of what it shows comes wholly from the canonical organ that enacted or handed it down, never from promulgation by the client itself (s. 3(6); [2026] REALM-SC 8). Where this condition fails, the artefact is an advice-producing product feature, outside the realm and severed (s. 14, s. 21(3); [2026] REALM-SC 5).
14. (e) ****Candour of provenance.**** The re-skinned nomenclature is disclosed to the user, on the whole of the contemporaneous interface, as descriptive presentation of canonical VJS governance and not as a separate, independent, locally-sovereign governance body (s. 5, s. 16).
15. (f) ****External-law floor / non-impersonation.**** Where a professional viewer may reasonably mistake the rendered governance for real-world legal authority, the client must affirmatively disclose, contemporaneously and at the point of use, that it renders VJS internal governance only, that the canonical bench names and ratios it shows carry no real-world legal force, that it is neither a regulated legal authority nor a substitute for real-world legal counsel, and that real-world law applies and is not displaced by any VJS permission (giving effect to [2026] REALM-SC 9; s. 14; s. 4; s. 5).
16. ****(3) Substance, not vocabulary.**** The lawful boundary is the substance the vocabulary clothes. Re-naming canonical governance into domain-appropriate professional terminology is permitted; re-housing the substantive law, the citator, the bench, the apex, or change-control inside the product is forbidden and is the competing sovereignty barred by s. 9, alterable if at all only by express deliberate amendment of s. 9. A re-skinned name or descriptive cause title is non-operative and void to the extent it ever governs which law applies or how a matter progresses (s. 21(4), s. 22(4)).
17. ****(4) The s. 16 limit; the source of the floor.**** The candour limb of s. 16 attaches to representations of delivered scope owed to the user (s. 16(1)-(2)) and does not, of itself, discharge the third-party non-impersonation duty in subsection (2)(f), which is anterior to and independent of it, arising under the external-law supremacy floor of [2026] REALM-SC 9 read with s. 14 and s. 5. A finding that the impersonation hazard is met by s. 16 candour alone is per incuriam under s. 11(e).

18. **“(5) Floor, not script; standard and remedy.”** Subsections (2)(e) and (2)(f) are satisfied by the result achieved on the whole contemporaneous interface, found as a fact; neither prescribes particular wording, placement, or prominence, the engineering means lying with the implementer at the reasonable-skill-and-care standard (s. 5). The responsible-body proviso (s. 5) cannot lower the subsection (2)(f) floor. Failure of any condition is a falling-below of the applicable standard (s. 5); the remedy is restorative, to make the arrangement or interface good (s. 6), and no punishment lies.
19. **“(6) Co-extensive permission and lapse.”** The permission is co-extensive with the six conditions and is not a status that survives their breach. A client that ceases to satisfy any condition as a found fact ceases to be a permitted division and is, to that extent, a forbidden domain COURT (s. 21(2)) or forbidden product-governance (s. 21(3)); in particular, a client that vendors its own local copy of CASE-LAW mints a subscribed local jurisdiction under s. 9(2)-(6) whatever its packaging, and the permission lapses at that instant. Failure is found entry-by-entry on the deterministic record and is never presumed from corporate packaging alone.
20. **“(7) Reach.”** This article binds every future server/client implementation, every subscribed jurisdiction, and every fork (s. 9, s. 22(2)).

21. ---

7. OVERRULES

22. No rulings overruled. [2026] REALM-SC 5, [2026] REALM-PC 8, [2026] REALM-PC 14, [2026] REALM-PC 15, [2026] REALM-SC 8, and [2026] REALM-SC 9 are each good law and are affirmed and applied. The First Instance ruling of Bowan J is **“varied, not overruled”**; its five-condition core stands as good law with the currency-of-source limb and the sixth condition added, and its s. 16 obiter is corrected, not set aside as void, the ratio having rested on other and sound grounds.
23. ---
24. --- **“Hallam CJ”**, delivering the judgment of the Court, with whom **“Goffe J, Blackmere J, Sumberly J, Elden J, and Steyne J”** concur in full; **“Bowan J”** concurs save as to the necessity of enactment; **“Coade J”** and **“Aldermere J”** concur in the disposal (VARY) and dissent only as to the discrete sixth condition, as recorded in Part 4.

1. An embeddable, corporate-re-skinned client that renders the same canonical VJS governance (CASE-LAW, the VPR, the bench constitution, the duty of care) served from the one central source of canonical law is a lawful non-operative presentation-layer DIVISION over the one spine (s. 21(1), s. 22(1), s. 9), and is not a forbidden parallel domain COURT (s. 21(2), s. 22(2)) nor forbidden product-as-governance (s. 21(3), s. 14), where and only where all six cumulative conditions are satisfied as found facts and not as labels (s. 21(4), s. 22(4); REALM-PC 14). 2. The governing line is substance and seat, not vocabulary: re-naming canonical governance into domain-appropriate professional terminology is permitted; re-housing the substantive law, citator, bench, apex, or change-control inside the product is forbidden as the competing sovereignty barred by s. 9. A re-skinned name is non-operative and void to the extent it ever governs which law applies or how a matter progresses. 3. The pivot is the source-of-force test (s. 3(6); REALM-SC 8): a client whose force comes from what it renders, gates, and explains is engineering (permitted); an artefact whose force comes from who promulgated it is law or adjudication. A client that merely delivers canonical governance, producing and promulgating nothing of its own, is the renderer; where it instead produces or generates advisory output of its own it is a product feature outside the realm and is severed (REALM-SC 5, s. 21(3)). Ownership of the renderer is not ownership of the law (s. 9(4)). 4. The six cumulative conditions are: (a) unity AND currency of law (canonical law applied unaltered, no local statute, and the rendered binding text resolves live to the central source as the apex enacts it, never a vendored, pinned, or stale copy whose currency the vendor's release cycle controls); (b) unity of citator and apex (one central citation series and single central apex, no parallel series, local apex, or per-domain citator); (c) the synthesiser bar (deliberation pattern borrowed as method only, no s. 18(4) synthesiser-on-top, no deciding bench of its own; rendering a ruling handed down by a properly constituted central bench instantiates no bench); (d) delivery-not-law-making (force is engineering deriving from the canonical organ, never from promulgation by the client); (e) candour of provenance to the user (s. 5, s. 16); and (f) the external-law floor / non-impersonation condition (REALM-SC 9 read with s. 14, s. 4, s. 5). 5. The candour limb of s. 16 attaches to representations of delivered scope owed to the user and does not, of itself, discharge the third-party non-impersonation duty in condition (f), which is anterior to and independent of it and arises under the external-law supremacy floor of REALM-SC 9 read with s. 14 and s. 5. A finding that the impersonation hazard is met by s. 16 candour alone is *per incuriam* (s. 11(e)). 6. Conditions (e) and (f) are a floor of substance, not a script of wording: they are satisfied by the result achieved on the whole contemporaneous interface, found as a fact, and prescribe no particular wording, placement, or prominence, the engineering means lying with the

implementer at the reasonable-skill-and-care standard (s. 5). The responsible-body proviso (s. 5) cannot lower the condition (f) floor. 7. The permission is co-extensive with the six conditions and lapses the instant any one fails as a found fact; the remedy for failure is restorative (s. 6), never punitive. In particular, a client that vendors its own local copy of CASE-LAW mints a subscribed local jurisdiction under s. 9(2)-(6) whatever its packaging, and the permission lapses at that instant. This article binds every future server/client implementation, every subscribed jurisdiction, and every fork (s. 9, s. 22(2)).

GOOD-LAW

Citation: [2026] REALM-SC 11

L **LEXBY - PLAIN ENGLISH TRANSLATION**
Lexby is an officer of this court. The bench speaks; Lexby translates.

SUMMARY

I'll write the plain-English translation now. --- Will, here is what just happened in the court, in plain English. I am writing as your counsel. ## 1. What the court was asked

The question was about a structure we wanted to build: an embeddable, corporate-re-skinned **client** that shows VJS governance inside a host product (think Opbox showing a panel that says "Client Decision" where the canon says "Court Ruling"), with the actual law served from one central place. We asked the court three things: - Is that a lawful **presentation layer** (just a different skin over the one shared system), or is it a forbidden **rival court** that secretly owns its own law? - The lower court (Bowen J, sitting alone) had set out **five conditions** the skin must meet to be lawful. Are five enough, or is a **sixth** needed to stop the skin from looking like a real, regulated legal authority to a watching lawyer? - If the test is sound, should it become permanent law, and how hard to change? This went straight to the full nine-judge court because you signed a leapfrog certificate and the question is foundational. ## 2. What each justice thought (one line each) - **Hallam CJ (lead, concur):** Re-skinning is fine because what matters is the *substance the words clothe*, not the words; the five conditions are right but a sixth (don't impersonate a real legal authority) is needed, grounded in our external-law floor, not in the candour rule. - **Goffe J (concur):** The test works in practice because it asks four mechanical yes/no questions a builder can actually check; add the sixth condition as a *result the interface must achieve*, not as prescribed wording. - **Blackmere J (concur):** Reading the statute word for word, the gap the sixth condition fills is real but is filled by a *different written rule* (the external-law floor), not by stretching the candour rule past its plain meaning. - **Sumberly J (concur):** Procedurally, the proposed citation was invalid and had to be fixed; on substance, the sixth condition is the *narrowest* rule needed to fill a genuine gap. - **Elden J (concur):** Looking at our prior cases, the five conditions are just faithful application of settled law; the sixth rests *solely* on the external-law floor, not on any "governance-laundering" worry, which our other conditions already handle. - **Coade J (part-dissent):** Affirm the five, but **no sixth condition** as a standalone rule, it's unnecessary and risks the court legislating product design; read the existing candour duty together with the external-law floor instead. - **Steyne J (concur):** I'll extend the law openly here because your position needs it and the landing is firm; candour-to-the-user and non-impersonation-to-a-bystander are genuinely different duties, so a sixth condition is owed. - **Bowan J (concur, dissent on enacting):** Sitting in review of my own earlier ruling, I correct my own mistake (I wrongly leaned on the candour rule), accept the sixth condition's substance, but I'd **not bother enacting a whole new statute** for what existing law already reaches. - **Aldermere J (part-dissent):** Affirm and vary, but **fold the sixth into a re-sourced fifth** rather than add a standalone condition; and add my "currency-of-source" point (the client must show the law live, not a frozen vendor copy), which the whole court adopted. ## 3. What the court decided and why **You win the core point, with a condition added.** The court was unanimous that a re-skinned client is lawful: it is a *presentation layer* over the one shared system, **not** a rival court. The reasoning is the line that runs through the whole judgment: **re-naming canonical governance is permitted; re-**

housing the actual law, the citator, the bench, or the apex inside the product is forbidden.** Calling a ruling a "Client Decision" doesn't change which law applies or how a matter is decided, so it's just a label, and labels are harmless. The deciding engine is the **source-of-for

Handed down by the SUPREME COURT of the Vibe Justice System (VJS). 10 June 2026.

Vibe Justice System